

Uddannelsesvalg efter folkeskolen



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Costa Rica. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

That's a great and important question — and it's fantastic that you're already thinking carefully about your next step! Since you've just finished primary school (**folkeskolen**) in Denmark at age 16, you have several good options depending on your interests, strengths, and future goals. Let me break it down for you:

Main educational paths after primary school in Denmark

Here are the typical options:

Gymnasiale uddannelser (Upper secondary school / high school level)

These are aimed at students who want to pursue higher education (like university or university colleges).

Main types:

- **STX (Almen studentereksamen)** – General upper secondary education, broad and academic, with lots of choice of subjects.
- **HHX (Højere handelseksamen)** – Focus on business, economics, and international trade.
- **HTX (Højere teknisk eksamen)** – Focus on technology, natural sciences, and innovation.
- **HF (Højere forberedelseeksamen)** – Shorter (2 years), often for students who prefer a more practical or mature learning style, or want access to certain university programs.

 Choose this route if:

- You enjoy academic subjects.
- You think you may want to go to university or higher education.
- You're curious to explore more subjects before specializing.

Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational education and training / EUD)

This is for those who want to combine school and apprenticeship (praktik). You train for a specific job (e.g., carpenter, chef, electrician, hairdresser, etc.).

 Choose this route if:

- You like working with your hands or practical tasks.
- You're eager to get into the job market sooner.
- You want to earn while you learn.

Kombinerede forløb (e.g. EUX)

A mix of vocational training + a gymnasium-level exam. This lets you qualify for university *and* learn a trade.

 Choose this route if:

- You want to keep doors open (both practical job and higher education).
- You like variety (both school and hands-on work).

Considering your background

Since you're fluent in Danish and have roots in Costa Rica:

- ✓ You could consider language-heavy or international studies (e.g. STX with Spanish or global studies).
- ✓ HHX might appeal if you're interested in business, international trade, or perhaps working with Latin America.
- ✓ A gymnasium education also gives you the option to study or work abroad later, which could connect you with Costa Rica or other Spanish-speaking countries.

My advice

- ➔ **If you're unsure what you want yet:** STX or HHX is a safe choice because it keeps many doors open.
- ➔ **If you love working practically or already have a dream job in mind:** EUD or EUX can be a great, direct path.
- ➔ **If you like the idea of international opportunities, business, or languages:** HHX could fit really well.

Next steps

-  Visit open house events (åbent hus) at local schools.
-  Talk to a guidance counselor (UU-vejleder) — they can help you choose what fits you.
-  Think about what subjects you enjoy most, and what kind of school environment you thrive in.

If you want, tell me:

- What subjects do you like best?
- Do you prefer theory or practical learning?
- Do you already have a career dream?

Then I can give you a more personalized recommendation! 